WHY THE MOUNTAIN TURNED DEADLY

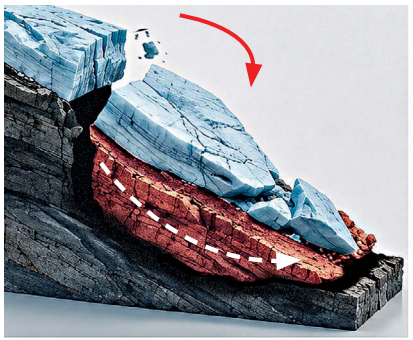
A high-altitude glacier collapse in Nepal triggered a cascading torrent that raced through Himalayan valleys, wreaking havoc far downstream

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS** | *Text by* **JUMANA SHAH**

1 **8:37 AM**

THE MAIN COLLAPSE

A massive section of a glacier and bedrock detaches from a high-altitude slope (17,000 feet above sea level) on the Langtang Lirung peak



The force of millions of tonnes of ice and rock slamming around 1,200 metres down into the valley floor registers as a magnitude 5.2 seismic event

2 **8:37 AM-8:39 AM**

THE DEBRIS FLOW

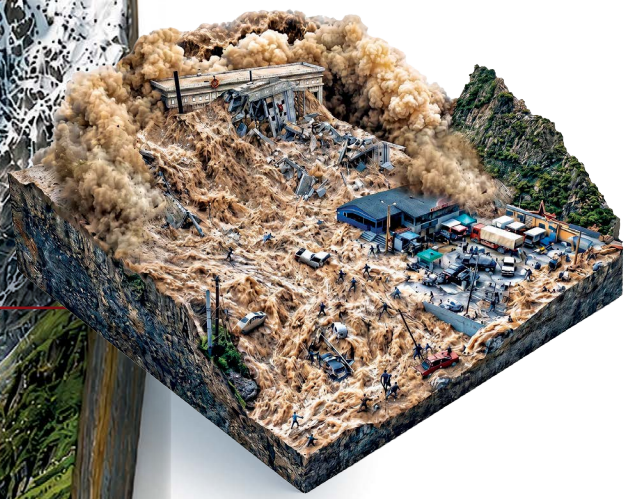
The rock and ice avalanche hits the Lhende Khola River near the Tibet-Nepal border, moving at extreme speeds, 180 kmph



3 **8:44 AM**

BORDER INUNDATION

A towering wall of mud and boulders—cresting at up to 260 feet high—completely buries the Gyirong Port/Rasuwagadhi border checkpoint between China and Nepal



4 **AROUND 8:45 AM**

RASUWAGADHI HYDROPOWER PROJECT

Extensive damage reported to the 111 MW hydropower project and surrounding infrastructure

